

E017

Agile Processes and Culture in Technology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A startup that just raised \$3 million, and whose office has a rooftop garden, is building a new customer app. It does not yet know which features users want and expects feedback to change its plans often. Which approach fits best?

- A. A predictive approach with a full specification up front.
- B. An agile, iterative approach with frequent user feedback.
- C. Predictive, because \$3 million in funding needs a fixed plan.
- D. Agile, because it is faster for every kind of project.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which project is the best fit for a predictive (plan-driven) approach?

- A. Installing a fire-alarm system whose requirements are fixed by building code.
- B. Prototyping an experimental machine-learning feature.
- C. Building a new app whose target users are still unclear.
- D. None; agile is always the better choice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A technology leader at a 90-year-old insurance company, headquartered in a converted warehouse, wants to spread agile across 12 teams. Many managers are skeptical. What is the most effective strategy?

- A. Require all 12 teams to switch next Monday.
- B. Rename existing roles and meetings with agile terms.
- C. Start with a willing pilot team, share visible results, model agile behaviors as a leader, then expand.
- D. Wait for retirements, since a 90-year-old company cannot change.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A vice president notes that Team A, which sits near her office, averages 60 story points per sprint while Team B, working on a legacy billing system, averages 30. She concludes Team B is half as productive. What is the best response?

- A. Agree that Team B is half as productive.
- B. Ask Team B to inflate its estimates to match Team A.
- C. Explain that Team B is slower because of the legacy system.
- D. Velocity is team-specific and cannot be compared across teams.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What is velocity appropriately used for?

- A. Rating individuals in performance reviews.
- B. Helping a team forecast how much work it can take on in future sprints.
- C. Ranking teams against each other.
- D. Measuring the business value delivered.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A six-engineer infrastructure team supports three data centers. It handles urgent, unpredictable requests every day, and its two-week sprint plans are disrupted almost every sprint. Which change fits best?

- A. Hire more engineers for each data center.
- B. Keep Scrum and refuse all new requests mid-sprint.
- C. Lengthen sprints to four weeks.
- D. Move to Kanban with continuous flow and WIP limits.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A product team building a new app wants a regular rhythm for planning commitments and getting stakeholder feedback on finished work. Which framework fits best?

- A. Scrum, with time-boxed sprints and sprint reviews.
- B. A waterfall plan with one review at the end.
- C. Neither; frameworks never help product teams.
- D. Kanban with no scheduled planning or reviews.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A team waits five days for a security approval before every deployment. Its agile leader recently completed a certification course, and team morale surveys are positive. What is the leader's best action?

- A. Tell the team to plan around the delay and work harder.
- B. Leave it alone, since morale is positive.
- C. Work with the security group to build a faster review path, such as pre-approved patterns or embedded review.
- D. Personally approve deployments and skip security review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Every feature passes from a UI team to an API team to a database team to a QA team. Each feature takes about six weeks, mostly waiting between teams. The company recently moved to a new HR system. What change best cuts delivery time?

- A. Add a coordinator to manage the handoffs.
- B. Ask each component team to work faster.
- C. Form cross-functional teams that deliver features end to end.
- D. Reorganize teams in the new HR system.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Five teams build parts of one product. Two of the teams are offshore, and each team uses a different chat tool. Teams keep discovering dependencies on each other late in their sprints. What change helps most?

- A. Hold joint planning on a shared cadence so teams map dependencies up front.
- B. Have each team plan more carefully on its own.
- C. Merge all five teams into one large team.
- D. Standardize everyone on one chat tool.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Three features are ranked by weighted shortest job first. Feature A: cost of delay 20, job size 10. Feature B: cost of delay 12, job size 3. Feature C, requested by the largest client: cost of delay 30, job size 20. Which should go first?

- A.** All three at once, since every feature is top priority.
- B.** Feature B.
- C.** Feature C, because the largest client requested it.
- D.** Feature C, because it has the highest cost of delay.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Feature D has a cost of delay of 18. What is the largest job size it can have and still reach a WSJF of at least 3.0?

- A.** 54
- B.** 3
- C.** 15
- D.** 6

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A startup ~~that just raised \$3 million, and whose office has a rooftop garden~~, is building a new customer app. It does not yet know which features users want and expects feedback to change its plans often. Which approach fits best?

Target word: approach fit **Decides:** Requirements are unclear and will change.

A	Inverted operation	Locks in requirements that are expected to change.
B	Correct	Agile handles uncertainty by learning in short cycles.
C	Camouflage	Funding amount does not decide the approach.
D	Absolute language	Agile fits this case because of uncertainty, not in all cases.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which project is the best fit for a predictive (plan-driven) approach?

Target word: pick the predictive fit — reverse direction **Decides:** Stable, fully known requirements.

A	Correct	Stable, well-defined requirements suit up-front planning.
B	Confusion set	Research work changes as teams learn.
C	Inverted operation	High uncertainty favors agile.
D	Absolute language	Predictive approaches suit stable work.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A technology leader at a 90-year-old insurance company, ~~headquartered in a converted warehouse~~, wants to spread agile across 12 teams. Many managers are skeptical. What is the most effective strategy?

Target word: culture-change strategy **Decides:** Skeptical organization; many teams.

A	Inverted operation	A big-bang mandate tends to harden resistance.
B	Adjacent category	Changes labels without changing how people work.
C	Correct	Early wins and leader modeling build credibility for wider change.
D	Camouflage	Company age does not prevent culture change.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A vice president notes that Team A, ~~which sits near her office~~, averages 60 story points per sprint while Team B, ~~working on a legacy billing system~~, averages 30. She concludes Team B is half as productive. What is the best response?

Target word: interpreting velocity **Decides:** Story points are calibrated within each team.

A	Confusion set	Treats points as a shared unit of output.
B	Inverted operation	Games the metric without improving delivery.
C	Camouflage	Still accepts the invalid comparison.
D	Correct	Each team sizes points differently; velocity is for its own forecasting.

5. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

What is velocity appropriately used for?

Target word: proper use — reverse of the misuse item **Decides:** A team's own planning.

A	Adjacent category	Velocity is a team measure and invites gaming if used on individuals.
B	Correct	Velocity is a team-level planning aid.
C	Inverted operation	Points are not comparable across teams.
D	Confusion set	Points measure effort, not value.

6. Answer D Concept 4

~~A six-engineer infrastructure team supports three data centers. It handles urgent, unpredictable requests every day, and its two-week sprint plans are disrupted almost every sprint. Which change fits best?~~

Target word: framework fit **Decides:** Work arrives unpredictably and cannot wait.

A	Camouflage	Staffing does not fix the mismatch between framework and work.
B	Adjacent category	Urgent operational work cannot simply wait.
C	Inverted operation	Longer sprints make disruptions worse.
D	Correct	Kanban handles work as it arrives without sprint commitments.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A product team building a new app wants a regular rhythm for planning commitments and getting stakeholder feedback on finished work. Which framework fits best?

Target word: framework fit — reverse direction **Decides:** Planned work that benefits from regular cadence.

A	Correct	Scrum builds in planning and feedback on a fixed cadence.
B	Adjacent category	Feedback arrives too late.
C	Absolute language	Frameworks add useful structure.
D	Confusion set	Drops the regular rhythm the team wants.

8. Answer C Concept 5

~~A team waits five days for a security approval before every deployment. Its agile leader recently completed a certification course, and team morale surveys are positive. What is the leader's best action?~~

Target word: servant-leader action **Decides:** A recurring impediment outside the team.

A	Dropped element	Drops the leader's role in removing impediments.
B	Camouflage	Positive morale does not remove a five-day wait.
C	Correct	Removes the impediment while keeping the control.
D	Inverted operation	Bypasses a needed control.

9. Answer C Concept 6

Every feature passes from a UI team to an API team to a database team to a QA team. Each feature takes about six weeks, mostly waiting between teams. ~~The company recently moved to a new HR system.~~ What change best cuts delivery time?

Target word: structural fix **Decides:** Handoffs between specialist teams cause the waiting.

A	Adjacent category	Manages handoffs instead of removing them.
B	Dropped element	Drops the waiting, which is most of the six weeks.
C	Correct	Removes handoffs and the waiting between them.
D	Camouflage	The HR tool has nothing to do with the delay.

10. Answer A Concept 7

Five teams build parts of one product. ~~Two of the teams are offshore, and each team uses a different chat tool.~~ Teams keep discovering dependencies on each other late in their sprints. What change helps most?

Target word: multi-team coordination **Decides:** Dependencies surface too late.

A	Correct	Joint planning surfaces dependencies before work starts.
B	Inverted operation	Separate planning is what hides the dependencies.
C	Adjacent category	A very large team loses agility and adds communication overhead.
D	Camouflage	A common tool alone does not surface dependencies early.

11. Answer B Concept 8

Three features are ranked by weighted shortest job first. Feature A: cost of delay 20, job size 10. Feature B: cost of delay 12, job size 3. Feature C, ~~requested by the largest client~~: cost of delay 30, job size 20. Which should go first?

Target word: highest WSJF **Decides:** A = 2.0, B = 4.0, C = 1.5.

A	Absolute language	WSJF exists to sequence work.
B	Correct	$12 / 3 = 4.0$, the highest ratio.
C	Camouflage	Requester size is not part of WSJF.
D	Dropped element	Drops job size from the ratio.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

Feature D has a cost of delay of 18. What is the largest job size it can have and still reach a WSJF of at least 3.0?

Target word: solve for job size **Decides:** Job size = cost of delay / WSJF.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
B	Wrong stem number	The target WSJF, not a job size.
C	Confusion set	Subtracts the target from the cost of delay.
D	Correct	$18 / 3.0 = 6$.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	When agile fits	Agile fits high uncertainty and changing requirements; predictive (plan-driven) fits stable, well-understood, fixed requirements.	Treating agile as always better or funding level as the deciding factor.	How clear and stable the requirements are.
2	Growing an agile culture	Start with a willing pilot team, make results visible, have leaders model agile behavior, then expand.	Mandating a big-bang switch or renaming meetings without changing mindset.	A leader asked to spread agile across a cautious organization.
3	Velocity is team-relative	Velocity helps one team forecast its own capacity; story points are not comparable across teams.	Ranking teams or judging productivity by velocity.	Two teams' velocities compared side by side.
4	Scrum vs. Kanban fit	Scrum's time-boxed sprints suit planned product work with regular feedback; Kanban's continuous flow suits unpredictable, interrupt-driven work.	Lengthening sprints or forbidding urgent work when interruptions are the nature of the job.	Sprint plans that keep getting blown up by urgent requests.
5	Servant leadership	Agile leaders remove impediments and build better systems for the team rather than directing tasks or bypassing controls.	Telling the team to push harder or personally overriding governance.	A recurring blocker outside the team's control.
6	Cross-functional teams	Teams that hold all the skills to deliver a feature end to end cut handoffs and waiting.	Adding coordinators or speeding up component teams while handoffs remain.	Features passing through several specialist teams.
7	Coordinating multiple teams	When teams share a product, joint planning on a common cadence surfaces dependencies early.	Having each team plan harder on its own, or merging into one huge team.	Several teams blocking each other with late-found dependencies.
8	Weighted shortest job first	WSJF = cost of delay / job size; do the highest ratio first.	Ranking by cost of delay alone or by who asked.	Features with cost-of-delay and size estimates.

Course scope (public description): Agile Processes and Culture in Technology provides technology leaders with a framework for adapting to changing business needs and environments. Agile approaches enable teams and individuals to reduce the impact of change on projects and strategies, maintaining top velocity despite uncertainty, unexpected contingencies, or change in client requests. Students will learn how agile process can improve efficiencies; they will apply an agile framework to a business scenario; and they will strategize how to promote an agile culture within an organization, improving resilience to the constant changes they will encounter as technology leaders. There are no prerequisites for this course.